Search Engine

Student News

Messageboard

Rapid Response

Academic Resources



Visit Web App &
LinkedIn Company Profile

Support For Students,
Developed By Students

Knobull.com

Top Ranked Academic Search Engine



Tired Of Academic Challenges? Secure Top Ranked Academic Search Engine & Single Source Student Guidance Tools Can Help!

Knobull, Inc.

Research Success Guide

The scope and focus of your paper or project will depend on the assignment requirements, but here is where you answer the question "what do I want to find out?" Identify your Thesis Statement or Research Question: This is the main point of your project or paper. This is the fundamental question you will be researching. Remember to start broad and narrow your topic as you go. It is easier to narrow your focus than to broaden it out.

Gather Information

Next you should gather the basic information about your topic. Make sure you have a firm understanding of the subject before you dive into your research. This is a perfect time to do a Knobull academic search and see what the Wikipedia page has to say about the topic you've chosen. It has been reported that many researchers prefer using the Knobull Academic Search Engine over most other options!

Start your research by locating what resources (books, articles, etc.) you want to include. And remember, you can use the materials you found during your preliminary search as well. Be mindful of the types of materials your professor is asking for. If they require something special or unique, make sure it is included in your resources and references.

Don't let the length of academic materials overwhelm you. Use the information you gathered during your preliminary search to pinpoint what you are looking for. When reading materials, look for major topics and sections that connect to your research, background information that expands your knowledge, and specific chapters and sections that address what you need.

And you don't need to read every word. **Skim** first: find the information and sections that look interesting and connect to your topic, and then read those sections.

Organize Information

As you read through your research materials, take notes. Add the information gathered into an outline to organize both you thoughts and you project or paper. A **5 Point Outline** is a basic and easy way to stay organized. You can add more main points (for longer papers) and add subpoints to expand each main point. Check out the 5 point outline below.

1. Introduction
2. Main Point 1
3. Main Point 2
4. Main Point 3
5. Conclusion

The easiest way to ensure you remember to give credit to every source you used, is to cite as you go. Don't wait until the very end to create your citations. Every time you pull a direct quote, paraphrase or summarize, and use others' ideas, make sure you create a citation.

As you read through the materials you gathered, take note on the areas that are being covered over and over again. Will these points help to drive your Thesis Statement forward? If you are writing a persuasive paper, these are often the key points to your argument. If you are writing an analysis, these are often your key themes. You should know roughly what your main points will be when you start gathering your research, but main points can develop and change as you work through your research. That's okay. Expand your developed main points in an expanded outline.

Begin To Formulate Results

As you write, you will notice some areas of your paper make a lot of sense and seem really good, while other areas do not. You most likely have noticed:

- This is no longer a major section and should be added to another section.
- This is a major section, but needs to be developed and expanded further.
- You are missing something that your research is pointing to.
- There is an area you should continue to research and work within.

Realizing these points is perfectly natural and okay. Go back to your outline and rearrange as needed so you can edit and incorporate new information without starting over. The trick to a great paper or project is to critically examine all aspects of your work.

Complete Rough Draft

Now you should have all of the materials and information needed to finish up your rough draft. You've located any additional information and have finished drafting your paper. Next is to rewrite and rework to make sure everything makes sense and connects together, supporting your thesis statement.

Don't Forget: Remember to write your introduction and conclusion. Wrap everything up and ensure it connects throughout. Read through your paper to make sure your thoughts flow and make sense. Reading your work **out loud** will help to catch any funky bits that you might have missed when reading through the first time. You can also request help from a member of the Knobull team.

Finalize Research Findings

You are almost there! Your thoughts and arguments make sense, but you will still need to make sure your spelling and grammar are on par. Get rid of filler words and conjunctions. Once you've edited your work yourself, you can request a review by a member of the Knobull team to get another set of eyes to read your paper.

If at any point you have questions, ask your professor or a school librarian. Also remember: **We're here to help.** Just because this information is available doesn't mean we won't take the time to show you the finer points, or walk you through a section that doesn't make sense. If at any point in the process above you fell like you're getting stuck, let us know. Our job is to help get you unstuck!

Chat with your Knobull expert to improve career search, academic research, coursework, presentation + more success!